Saving safely: make a small goal workable

Week 3 • MoneyWise SHS • Objective O4

Start with a purpose

Ama’s fictional goal is a GHS80 textbook set in eight weeks. Dividing 80 by 8 gives GHS10 per week. The arithmetic is simple, but the plan must also leave enough for essential needs.

Check whether the amount fits

In a practice week, Ama has GHS50 available. Essential items total GHS35. Setting aside GHS10 leaves GHS5 for other planned spending. Check: 35 + 10 + 5 = 50. These are teaching figures, not a recommended allowance.

Plan, record, review

Write the goal, target amount, weeks and weekly contribution. Record progress regularly. If the affordable amount changes, revise the deadline or goal rather than pretending the target has been met.

Your turn

Kojo wants a fictional GHS60 study lamp in six weeks. Work out the weekly amount and show how it could fit a practice budget. Compare your reasoning with a classmate. Answer: GHS10 each week; the budget must still cover essentials.

This lesson uses fictional money. Do not transfer funds or open an account to complete it.

Protect the plan as well as the money

Discuss an appropriate saving arrangement

With the facilitator or a trusted adult, check whether a provider is licensed and whether its age requirements, charges and withdrawal arrangements fit the learner's situation. A name or attractive return does not establish suitability. Do not assume a licensed product is risk-free.

Keep access private

Do not share a PIN or verification code, including in a group task. Verify account messages independently through the provider's known official channels. Ask the facilitator for help with an unexpected claim or demand.

Build your group plan

Agree one small fictional goal, show the weekly calculation, explain a suitable saving arrangement and identify one risk with a response. Each member contributes an idea and replies to another member. Complete the individual checklist after the shared task.

Quick self-check

Can I explain my goal and deadline? Does the calculation reach the target? Are essentials covered? Have I checked access, costs and eligibility? Can I describe a safe response to a suspicious message?

Reading sources

Bank of Ghana, Financial Literacy on Savings (2025): bog.gov.gh/wp-content/uploads/2025/06/BOG-FINANCIAL-LITERACY-ON-SAVINGS.pdf. Cyber Security Authority, Mobile Money Fraud: csa.gov.gh/mobile_money_fraud.php. Accessed 19 October 2026.